

Problem Set 2

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Setup

Telling a Story through Visualization

Democratic backsliding has become a buzzword and popular topic in international affairs. Using the Varieties of Democracy dataset, I sought to examine the change in electoral democracy across the world, but specifically within a couple key Latin American cases. I used the `v2x_polyarchy` variable, which is the Electoral Democracy Index, which measures the extent to which the ideal of electoral democracy in its fullest sense is achieved. The variable itself uses a 0 (low electoral democracy)-1 (high electoral democracy). To get a better picture of the state of democracy in the world today (2023 is the most recent year with data in the VDem dataset) as compared to 2010, I started with some basic statistics.

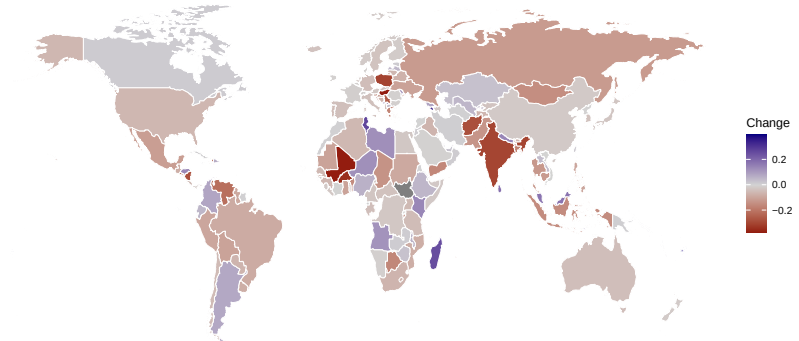
year	mean
2010	0.525
2023	0.494

The average Electoral Democracy Index in 2010 for the entire world was .525, and in 2010, it was .494. Therefore, electoral democracy in the world on average has seen a decrease of .031 points on the electoral democracy index in the past decade. This is even better visualized in a

Mapping the decline in electoral democracy throughout the world.

Change in Electoral Democracy (2010–2023)

Red = Backsliding | Blue = Improvement



Source: V-Dem